

LAHAUL-SPITI | Heady Row

**ALL FUTURE
INCREDIBLE
INDIA ROAD-
SHOWS
ABROAD
HAVE BEEN
CANCELLED BY
THE PMO AS
AN AUSTERITY
MEASURE.**

**THE 2007 ROAD-
SHOW IN NEW YORK**

Tribal women in the Rohtang region are protesting the sale of Indian Made Foreign Liquor (IMFL) since it casts a bad influence on the men, particularly the youth. IMFL has pushed down sales of the local chhang and ara, mostly brewed by local women. "IMFL has deprived women of their income from traditional brews," says Ram Lal Markanda, BJP MLA from Lahaul-Spiti. Mahila Mandals of 15 panchayats have imposed a fine of Rs 5,000 on anyone drinking IMFL.

by Ramesh Vinayak



ANIL DAYAL

Low Carbs

India's carbon trading business is feeling the heat of the global recession. Its big buyers, the US and the EU, have been the worst hit. The price of carbon emission reduction (CER) units is down by €7 per unit. India could generate about 32 million CERS annually based on registered projects. But due to the economic crisis, says carbon trading consultancy Emergent Ventures, Indian companies could now lose up to Rs 1,400 crore annually. Buyers are wary as prices could fall further.

by Nandini Vaish

DELHI | Incredible Halt

The prime minister's call for austerity measures has taken on a new urgency in light of the financial 9/11 that has crippled the world's economies. And since India is no longer that incredible, one of the major campaigns to bite the dust is the high-profile Incredible India roadshow. After New York, Berlin, Tokyo and Beijing, the next stop was a 15-day culture-cum-cuisine blitzkrieg covering Russia and the former Soviet republics. The request for clearance sent from the ministry was returned by the PMO with a one-word response: Rejected.



ASHOK K. DAMODARAN

CHOPRA HAD AN UNCANNY UNDERSTANDING OF THE DEMANDS OF MODERN CINEMA.

OBITUARY | B.R. CHOPRA 1914-2008

It is ironic that the man enshrined in public memory as the creator of Doordarshan's wildly popular *Mahabharat* (1988) was one of the most progressive and prolific filmmakers of Bollywood. His work was always controversial, whether it was the Luddite *Naya Daur* in 1957 where a horse carriage outdoes an automobile; *Gumraah* (1963), where the adulterous wife goes back to the husband, or *Insaf Ka Tarazu* (1980), one of the first Bollywood films to explicitly show the brutality of rape. Far ahead of his contemporaries in terms of understanding the demands of modern cinema, he worked with the finest writers of his era, Akhtar Mirza, Akhtar-ul Iman and Sahir. Not surprisingly, the Dadasaheb Phalke Award winner was editor of a film magazine in pre-Partition Lahore.



FAWZAN HUSIAN